

Week 2 — Strategic Design & Metrics

"If you cannot measure what 'better' looks like, you are not doing strategy. You are doing wishful feature delivery."

Week 2 converts the customer understanding built in Week 1 into something **measurable, designable, and prioritized**. Every quad arrives Monday with a problem statement; they leave Friday with a strategy & metrics package they can defend in front of an engineering lead.

Quads from Week 1 persist (they carry the mini-capstone in Week 3). The shared **FieldPulse** case continues — by Friday, each quad's package is grounded in FieldPulse evidence.

Learning outcomes

By Friday afternoon, each participant can:

1. Distinguish operational signals, KPIs, and a North Star — and explain how a change in one is supposed to ripple to the others.
2. Propose a North Star metric for a product and defend it against three standard pitfalls (vanity metric, leading-indicator confusion, gameable targets).
3. Apply core UX heuristics (Nielsen's 10, accessibility minimums) to audit a real product surface and produce a short list of design principles a TPM-engineer pair can ship against.
4. Use AI to compile a multi-source research summary with evidence tagging, and detect when the AI is over-confident relative to its inputs.
5. Build a customer journey map that connects observed pain points (from Week 1) to a prioritized list of feature concepts.

Daily map

Day	Topic	Key artifact produced
1	Operational signals & KPIs	Metrics tier sheet (quad)
2	Defining the North Star metric	North Star proposal + supporting metrics (quad)
3	Product design & UX principles	UX audit + 3 design principles (quad)
4	Using AI for strategy & research summaries	AI-assembled strategy brief (quad)
5	Customer journey mapping	Journey map + prioritized feature concepts (quad, presented)

Each day's artifact feeds the next. Friday readouts are the seed of every quad's Week 3 PRD.

Daily cadence (applies every day)

Clock	Block	Mix
09:00 – 09:15	Opening & objectives	Instructor
09:15 – 10:30	Teaching Block 1 + Activity 1	~25 min teach / 50 min group
10:30 – 10:45	Break	
10:45 – 12:00	Teaching Block 2 + Activity 2	~25 min teach / 50 min group
12:00 – 13:00	Lunch	
13:00 – 14:15	Teaching Block 3 + Activity 3	~25 min teach / 50 min group
14:15 – 14:30	Break	
14:30 – 16:00	Teaching Block 4 + Activity 4 + Readouts + Wrap	~25 min teach / 45 min group / 20 min readout

Group composition: quads carry over from Week 1. If a participant joined late, place them in the smallest existing quad rather than forming new groups.

Materials referenced across the week

- `day-01-metrics-kpis.md` — Metrics Tier Sheet, vanity-metric examples
- `day-02-north-star.md` — North Star pitfalls card, candidate-evaluation rubric
- `day-03-design-ux.md` — UX heuristics card, audit template
- `day-04-ai-research-summaries.md` — Strategy brief template, evidence-tag schema
- `day-05-journey-mapping.md` — Journey map canvas, feature-prioritization frame

Week 2 readout rubric (Friday afternoon)

Each quad presents a **12-minute integrated strategy package**:
North Star → supporting metrics → 1 design principle → journey map → top 3 feature concepts. Peer and instructor score on:

Dimension	Weight	What "exemplary" looks like
Metric coherence	25%	NS, KPIs, and operational signals form a believable causal chain — change in operational signal plausibly ripples up
North Star defense	20%	Quad can name and rebut three pitfalls applied to their own NS
Journey realism	20%	Journey map references observed Week-1 pain points; not generic
Feature linkage	15%	Each top feature ties to a specific journey friction point AND a metric it would move
AI-use transparency	10%	Where AI summarized research, prompts and validation steps are disclosed
Design awareness	10%	At least one UX principle is named and its trade-off acknowledged

Bridge to Week 3

Week 3 turns each quad's strategy package into a **Technical PRD** — Acceptance Criteria, Non-Functional Requirements, and a non-AI mini-capstone. The journey map and prioritized feature concepts produced Friday of Week 2 are the **direct input** to Monday's PRD drafting in Week 3. Do not let quads leave Friday without those two artifacts in shareable form.